

Seek out smaller companies that cater to your topic area. Working with smaller companies will be much easier as they will be more amenable to work with you than larger companies. Building a solid base of advertisers will be hard work initially but in the end, it will provide with you with a solid source of income.

4.2.2.4 Affiliate Programs

An affiliate in the strictest sense of the word is a partner that works with an advertising network to sell/display their ad inventory. By this definition, all ad networks use affiliate programs to sell different ad products including contextual and display advertising. The distinction between affiliate programs and other types of ad programs is in the revenue model. In an affiliate program, the revenue model is usually measured in terms of CPA—Cost Per Action as against CPC (Cost per Click) or CPM (Cost per thousand impressions). That is, the advertiser will pay for a specific action from the user. This could be something as simple as registering for free on a Web site or more complicated like buying a product. This affiliate CPA model requires hard work and may not be applicable in all circumstances. Some of the top affiliate programs include:

Amazon Associates:

<http://affiliate-program.amazon.com/gp/associates/join>

Join Associates

Already a member? [Sign in](#). Want to join? [Click here](#) for more information.

Launched in 1996, Associates is Amazon.com's affiliate marketing program. By linking to Amazon.com, you can add compelling content for your site visitors' enjoyment and receive up to 10% in ref. fee for doing so.

As one of the first online affiliate marketing programs, Associates has a 10-year track record of diverse solutions to help website owners, Web developers, and Amazon sellers make money. Our talent roster includes authors, bloggers, and more.

Current participants in the Amazon Associates program include large, well-known sites, niche content blogs, comparison shopping engines, search engine marketers, and everything in between. Visit our [Associates page](#) to see how some of these websites are using our solutions.

How the Program Works

1. Associates drive internet traffic to Amazon.com through specially formatted links that allow us to track sales and other activity.
2. Associates earn up to 10% in referral fees on all qualifying revenue made through their links.
3. We send quarterly payment to Associates.

Once you [join the program](#), we will give you access to Associate Central, our website exclusive to the Associates. This is the place where you will build your links, view your affiliate earnings results, and about the latest news and opportunities available to you through the program.